



Hybrid Laptops

Part tablet, part conventional laptop, we're happy to say that hybrid devices are now becoming mainstream items in manufacturers' portfolio in 2014. They aren't that widespread yet, but you'll be hard pressed to find an electronic store that doesn't house at least one exhibit. While all hybrid devices are technically laptops, not all of them are tablets in the strictest sense of the word. In the attempt to combine the best of both worlds, a few points to remember. Hybrid devices that are below the 50k mark, don't offer good performance for a laptop. They're also slightly bulky, so are hybrids with 13-inch or bigger screens, and uncomfortable to use as traditional tablets meant for single handed use — unless these hybrids have detachable screens. With time and continued human ingenuity, the hybrids will evolve into sleeker, more powerful devices, promising to do a lot more than we can ever think of right now. Until then, we have these.

Zero1 Winner

Acer Aspire R7-572G

This is unlike any hybrid you'd set your eyes on. It's a 15-inch laptop with a multitouch screen which can rotate and sit on top of the keyboard to transform into a large tablet at whim, thanks to its unique Ezel hinge design. While it hardly matters as far as pure performance goes, it should be mentioned that the Aspire R7's touchpad sits on top (and not below, as is the case traditionally) of its keyboard deck. Quirky design aside, the Aspire R7 doesn't set a foot wrong as far as performance is concerned, as its Intel Core i5 chip, 8GB of RAM, 1TB hard drive and NVIDIA GeForce GT 750M graphics with 2GB of GDDR3 VRAM is pretty much the most ambitious hybrid laptop you can get your hands on this year. Granted the graphics aren't meant for hardcore gaming, but with a score of 55.6 fps on Sniper Elite V2's benchmark doesn't wholly discount this hybrid device's gaming chops either. Its audio visual performance is a treat to enjoy, its screen is a gorgeous, 1080p panel that is bright and vibrant and very crisp, easily among the best we've seen on laptops so far. And all this very good performance doesn't affect the battery all that much — we pegged 2 hours 43 minutes in our battery test on high performance preset, which is pretty good given the hybrid's high-end components and large screen. A well-deserved winner!



ACER ASPIRE R7-572G

Price: ₹99,999

Worthy mentions

Lenovo IdeaPad YOGA 2

The Lenovo Yoga 2 is one of the few devices to offer a platform that elegantly embraces Windows 8's touch-friendly UI. As all of you must be aware by now, the Yoga's

360 degree hinge allows the device to seamlessly transition between traditional and pseudo-tablet modes. The device isn't all about the hinge though. Lenovo's always been known to make great laptops and the Yoga 2 is no exception. Its gorgeous screen is one of the first things that hits you when you look at the Yoga. It's about 30% brighter than most ultra-books and hybrids we've seen this year, and also offers a great contrast ratio.

The IdeaPad YOGA 2's overall performance figures are just a notch below the Acer Aspire R7's performance, with the exception of battery life, though, where the YOGA 2 is slightly better. As a thin laptop that can transform itself into a 13-inch tablet, there's no doubt in our minds when we say that the Lenovo YOGA 2 is one of the best performing hybrid devices you can buy this year.



Lenovo IdeaPad YOGA 2

Price: ₹59,990



HP Pro x2 612

Price: ₹70,000

HP Pro x2 612

A hybrid device which comes in close behind the heels of the Acer Aspire R7 and the Lenovo YOGA 2, the HP Pro x2 comes with a unique offering. With a detachable 12.5-inch screen (which is also a tablet in this case), the Pro x2 612 comes with not one but two keyboards — a standard keyboard that you'd find on any other HP laptop, and a smaller, lighter travel keyboard, which is remarkably similar to the keyboard found on the Microsoft Surface hybrid device. Its performance isn't flattering compared to the other two top performing hybrids listed here, but it does outperform both of them in one key department — battery life. With an Intel Core i5 chip and fast-paced SSD storage, this is a great hybrid device to consider if you want something light and powerful. 